ReleaseCrew: 18-month business plan (Nov 2026 – Apr 2028)

Every number in this plan is an assumption, not an actual. Month 0 = November 2026. Base case = Main scenario.

What we sell

ReleaseCrew is a crew of agents that turns a GitHub repo and release tag into a verified launch kit: changelog, X thread and a short trailer. A verifier rejects invented features, and durable state lets a failed run resume. Buyers are open-source maintainers, DX teams and product marketers who ship weekly and still write release notes by hand.

Plan	Monthly	Annual (2 months free)	Kits / month	Seats
Indie	$29	$290	20	1
Team	$149	$1,490	150	5
Launch	$499	$4,990	600	20

Overage is $2.50 per extra kit; trailers over 30s add $0.40.

How the business grows (Base)

We start with 40 Indie, 6 Team and 1 Launch customer, plus 12 Indie conversions from the neatHack waitlist in month 1. Indie adds 25 logos in month 1, growing 8% a month through month 8 and 4% after; Team adds 3, growing 10% then 4%; Launch adds one every other month. Monthly churn is 6% / 3% / 1.5%. Each year 8% of Indie upgrade to Team and 5% of Team upgrade to Launch. By month 6, 35% of Team and Launch pay annually.

By April 2028 the Base case reaches **~621 customers (503 Indie, 107 Team, 11 Launch)** and **$36.9k monthly revenue**. 18-month revenue totals **$331k**.

Margins

Kit cost is $0.24 fully loaded ($0.18 LLM, $0.04 render, $0.01 neatlogs, $0.01 storage). **Gross margin runs 92–93% from month 0**, so it clears the 80% target well before month 6. After card fees (2.9% + $0.30), contribution margin is 88–89%. In the Growth case, prompt caching and reserved render capacity cut kit cost to $0.16 from month 7, which lifts gross margin to ~95%.

Costs

Opex starts at $5.2k a month: founder at 0.5 FTE ($4,000), neatlogs Pro $500, cfo.ai $375 (paid yearly up front, $4,500), hosting $80, domain and extras $40, and marketing ($600 in months 1–2, then $250). The contractor ($2,000) starts in month 3 and the Entire cloud workspace ($200) in month 4. **Model assumption:** the founder goes full-time from month 6, adding $4,000 a month, so opex is $11.4k from May 2027.

Cash and runway (Base)

We start with $12,000 and raise nothing. **Cash bottoms out at $4.9k in December 2026** after the upfront cfo.ai payment and the launch-month loss, and never goes negative. Net income turns positive in March 2027 (month 4). **Cash is below 4 months of opex from day one and stays there until August 2027; it clears the floor in September 2027 (month 10)** and ends at $178k.

The risk is that thin early cushion: about $5k in the bank for the first quarter. A slow start to Indie sign-ups or one bad month would break it.

Growth case

In the Growth case Team adds 5 logos in month 1, growing 15% a month through month 8. Team passes 25 logos by month 5 (40 Team), which triggers the **$150k angel round in April 2027**. A $12k loaded engineer joins in month 7, and kit cost drops to $0.16. The result is **$52.2k monthly revenue by April 2028**, $443k revenue over 18 months, and $341k ending cash. Cash clears the 4-month floor in April 2027. The engineer pushes the P&L back into a loss for June–August 2027 (−$12.1k combined); it is positive again from September 2027.

Engineer payback. If we credit all of Growth's extra contribution over Base to the engineer, that extra contribution covers the $12k monthly cost from February 2028. Cumulative payback lands around **month 22 (Sep 2028), about 15 months after the hire**, which is just past this plan's window. The kit-cost savings on their own ($460–$1,330 a month) never pay for the role. Each engineer needs roughly **92 Team customers' worth of contribution**, and Growth passes 100 Team customers in September 2027.

Unit economics (Base, steady state)

	Indie	Team	Launch
ARPU / month	$30.76	~$148	~$497
Kits / customer / month	8.5	47	206
Contribution / customer / month	$27.53	~$131	~$431
LTV (24-month, contribution)	$355	~$2,265	~$8,750
CAC	$40	$220	$900
LTV : CAC	8.9x	10.3x	9.7x
CAC payback	1.5 mo	1.7 mo	2.1 mo

Blended ARPU is about $56 a month. COGS per kit is $0.24 ($0.16 in Growth from month 7).

Sensitivities and scenarios (18-month totals)

Scenario	Revenue	Net income	Lowest cash	Clears 4-mo floor	Ending cash
Base (Main)	$331k	$118k	$4.9k (Dec 26)	Sep 2027	$178k
Growth	$443k	$94k	$5.0k (Nov 26)	Apr 2027	$341k
Price cut (Team $99)	$290k	$78k	$3.9k (Dec 26)	Dec 2027	$125k
Hiring freeze	$331k	$119k	$5.0k (Nov 26)	Sep 2027	$179k
Indie churn 9%	$311k	$100k	$4.9k (Dec 26)	Sep 2027	$159k

- **Indie churn 6% → 9%:** −$20k revenue and −$19k ending cash. Indie LTV falls from $355 to ~$274 (6.9x CAC).
- **Team $149 → $99:** −$42k revenue and −$53k ending cash; the cash floor slips three months, and Team LTV:CAC falls to ~6.7x. To break even on revenue, the cut would need about 50% more Team customers. We should not cut price without evidence that it lifts conversion.
- **Hiring freeze:** nearly identical to Base, because Base already has no engineer; it only saves the $700 launch push.

What we're asking for and what would change the plan

Base is self-funding but runs on a thin cushion for its first 10 months. The $150k angel round in the Growth case buys time to hire the engineer and the cushion to absorb a weak quarter. The levers that move the plan most are Team logo growth, Indie churn and Team price, in that order.

Modeling notes and estimates: kit usage per customer (8 / 45 / 200 kits plus 0.5 / 2 / 6 overage kits) and the 15% long-trailer share are my estimates. Launch logos are smoothed to 0.5 a month. Team growth after month 8 is assumed at 4%. Annual payers ramp evenly to 35% by month 6, prepay 12 months, and renew at month 12. Card fees are charged on cash collected. Volume does not respond to the price cut or to the marketing cut.